

BIRMINGHAM CLAUDE IMPACT LAB

CHALLENGE 4 • HOMELESSNESS HANDOFF

What happens now?

Birmingham publishes eleven real cooling stations. Finding out whether any of them is open today turns out to be the hard part.

— A worked example, not a model answer



Marcus

Mid-fifties. Sleeping behind a shuttered storefront off 2nd Avenue North.

He is not in anyone's system. Nobody is looking for him. He needs somewhere cool for a few hours.

Drawn from SCEN-01 in the event's synthetic dataset. The person is invented. Every address in this deck is real.

TIME

11:14 AM

HEAT INDEX

99°F

STANDING NEXT TO HIM

An outreach volunteer with a phone, a pen, and about ten minutes before she has to move on.

She does not need a database. She needs to know one thing: **where can he go, right now, that is actually open.**

Three things that list does not tell you

95°

Whether they are open

The stations are activated, not standing. They open only when the heat index reaches 95°F, and an activation can begin later in the day.

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Who to call

The city publishes no phone number for any of the eleven. A workflow built on “call before anyone travels” gets nothing to dial.

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Who it serves

Only one station's eligibility is published anywhere, and not by the city. Pathways serves women and children only. Marcus is a man in his fifties.

211

is the one number that reaches a person, so everything routes there. But its own heat guidance lists no Birmingham addresses, and the county trail behind it goes cold. It is a referral line, not the city's activation system.

SO WE BUILT THE SMALLEST THING THAT HELPS

Let's look at it

THREE THINGS TO WATCH FOR

It refuses to help too early

No handoff exists until someone has called and written down what they were told.

A dead end is an answer

Not activated, or nobody could confirm?
No card is produced at all.

Eligibility rides along

Pick Pathways and watch where the restriction turns up on the card handed over.

WHAT THIS DOES NOT DO

The honest list

IT GOES STALE

The station list is a snapshot from one day. Nothing in the page can tell you when that stopped being true.

ENTRY RULES ARE UNKNOWN

No source states an ID or residency rule, and none rules one out. The card never claims “no ID needed” on its own authority.

NIGHTS ARE UNCOVERED

The latest any station closes is 8 p.m., and that is two libraries on Tuesdays. Ten of the eleven shut by 6, one at 12:30. On Sundays only two publish hours at all.

IT IS HEAT RELIEF, NOTHING MORE

Shelter and housing run through One Roof Coordinated Entry. This does not replace it, and never decides a placement.

Marcus is invented, and so is everything around him — the hour, the temperature, the street, the volunteer. The eleven stations, their addresses and their hours are real, and cited on slide 3.



NEXT STEP TOWARD A PILOT

Give it to one outreach team for a week of heat advisories

THEN ASK THEM ONE QUESTION

Did the person arrive, and was the building open when they got there?

Nothing else tells you whether the confirmation gate does any good. Until someone runs that week, the rest of this is a guess.

TWO CHEAPER ASKS

Ask the city to publish a phone number for each station. Their absence is the only reason this detours through 211.

Ask 211 whether it receives the city's activation notices. We could not establish that it does — and if it does not, the referral its own heat page recommends cannot be answered on the days it counts.